

Seat isn't official, but it may be reserved

County Supervisor Solis has her eye on new House district, keeping rivals at bay.

By Julia Wick

As Gov. Gavin Newsom's push to redraw California's congressional maps plays out at the state Capitol and on the national stage, a quieter but no less bloody scramble is simultaneously underway.

Newsom's plan — a bid to counter President Trump's drive for more GOP House seats with his own California show of force — was approved by the state Legislature on Thursday, putting it on the ballot in November to let voters decide its fate.

But behind the scenes, consultants, lawmakers and would-be candidates already are jockeying for position in the newly competitive or vastly redrawn districts that may soon exist across the state.

As rumblings emerged that there probably would be a new southeast Los Angeles County congressional seat — later confirmed by the official maps released last week — political watchers braced for a full-on feeding frenzy. A fresh seat in a safe Democratic district can be a once-in-a-generation opportunity, particularly in a region crowded with ambitious politicians.

But a race that doesn't even officially exist yet seems to already be practically tied up with a bow.

L.A. County Supervisor Hilda Solis hasn't publicly announced her candidacy. But she's made her intention to run for the redrawn 38th District clear within the close-knit world of California politics. And other would-be candidates appear to be staying out of the veteran politician's way.

[See Solis, A8]



IN THE ASSEMBLY, Republican Carl DeMaio, top, and Democrats Cecilia Aguiar-Curry, above center, and Celeste Rodriguez wrangle over redistricting.

How state feels about redistricting, Newsom

By Melody Gutierrez and Laura J. Nelson

SACRAMENTO — Gov. Gavin Newsom's plan to temporarily redraw California's congressional districts has more support than opposition — but with many voters undecided, the measure's prospects remain uncertain, a new poll found.

One thing, however, has become clear: Newsom's standing with voters appears tethered to the fate of

his high-stakes redistricting gamble.

The UC Berkeley Institute of Governmental Studies poll, conducted for the Los Angeles Times, asked registered voters about the Newsom-backed redistricting push favoring California Democrats, which serves as a counterattack to President Trump and Texas Republicans reworking election maps to their advantage.

When voters were asked whether they agree with Cal-

ifornia's redistricting maneuver, 46% said it was a good idea, while 36% said it was a bad idea. Slightly more, 48%, said they would vote in favor of the temporary gerrymandering efforts if it appeared on the statewide special election ballot in November. Nearly a third said they would vote no, while 20% said they were undecided.

"That's not bad news," said Mark DiCamillo, director of the Berkeley IGS Poll.

[See Poll, A7]

State's voters to decide on new House districts

California lawmakers back a November special election to boost Democrats.

By Laura J. Nelson, Seema Mehta and Melody Gutierrez

SACRAMENTO — Ratcheting up the pressure in the escalating national fight over control of Congress, the California Legislature on Thursday approved a November special election to ask voters to redraw the state's electoral lines to favor Democrats and thwart President Trump's far-right policy agenda.

The ballot measure, pushed by Gov. Gavin Newsom and other state and national Democratic leaders, is the latest volley in a national political brawl over electoral maps that could alter the outcome of the 2026 midterm elections and the balance of power in the U.S. House of Representatives.

If voters approve the redrawn lines on Nov. 4, Democrats in the Golden State would see the odds tilted further in their favor, while the number of California Republicans in the House could be halved.

Newsom initially said

that new electoral districts in California would take effect only if another state redrew its lines before 2031. But after Texas moved toward approving its own maps this week that could give the GOP five more House seats, Democrats stripped the so-called trigger language from the amendment — meaning that if voters approve the measure, the new lines would take effect no matter what.

"They fired the first shot, Texas," Newsom said before signing the bills Thursday. "We wouldn't be here if Texas had not done what they just did, if Donald Trump didn't do what he just did."

The ballot measure language, which asks California voters to override the power of the independent redistricting commission, was approved by most Democrats in the Assembly and the Senate, where they hold supermajorities.

Lawmakers have the power to place constitutional amendments on the statewide ballot without the approval of the governor. Newsom later signed two bills that fund the special election and spell out the lines for the new congressional districts.

[See Redistricting, A7]

Voters' approval of redistricting

More say it is a good idea to temporarily change the state's congressional district boundary lines ahead of next year's midterm elections to counter what Texas is doing.



Berkeley IGS poll

LORENA ELEBEE Los Angeles Times

Immigration to U.S. sees a historic fall

For the first time in more than half a century, immigrants leaving the U.S. outnumber those arriving, a phenomenon that may signal President Trump's historic mass deportation efforts are having the intended effect.

An analysis of census data released by Pew Research Center on Thursday noted that between January and June, the United States' foreign-born population had declined by more than a million people.

Millions of people arrived at the border between 2021 and 2023 seeking refuge in America after the COVID-19 pandemic emergency, which ravaged many of their home countries. In 2023, California was home to 11.3 million immigrants, roughly 28.4% of the national total, according to Pew.

In January, 53.3 million

For first time in 50 years, those leaving outnumber newcomers

By Hannah Fry



MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times

EXPERTS say Trump policies play a role in the immigration decline. In L.A., people rally against raids.

immigrants lived in the U.S., the highest number recorded, but in the months that followed, those who left or were deported surpassed those arriving — the first drop since the 1960s. As of June, the number living in the U.S. had dropped to 51.9 million. Pew did not calculate how many immigrants are undocumented.

Trump and his supporters have applauded the exodus, with the president declaring "Promises Made. Promises Kept," in a social media post this month.

"Seven months into his second term, it's clear that the president has done what he said he'd do by reestablishing law and order at our southern border and by removing violent illegal immigrants from our nation," Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem wrote in a

[See Immigration, A14]

EU leaders defend 15% tariff deal with U.S.

Taxes on steel, wine and spirits, among other products, remain unresolved.

By Sam McNeil, David McHugh and Fatima Hussein

American and European Union officials released a bare-bones account Thursday of their trade deal that imposes a 15% tax on 70% of European exports to the United States, but they left blank key areas such as wine and spirits, as well as steel, and indicated that talks would continue on those and a slew of other important

sectors.

The two sides said the document was only "a first step in a process that can be further expanded to cover additional areas." They are dealing with the vast variety of goods traded between the two economies in what is the largest bilateral trading relationship in the world, involving \$2 trillion in annual transatlantic business.

The 3½-page text represents a political commitment and is not legally binding. It contrasts with the typical format for trade agreements, which can be hundreds of pages long and carry legal force.

The key provisions are the 15% tariff on most EU

[See Trade, A11]

Self-deportee is arrested. Punishment: Deportation

Salvadoran man tried to use the DIY process, but he didn't get the chance.

By Clara Harter

A Salvadoran man with a criminal record decided to heed the advice of the Trump administration and self-deport, his attorney said.

But as he waited to board a flight at San Francisco In-

ternational Airport bound for San Salvador, he was arrested by federal agents.

After his three weeks in custody, a federal court convicted Jeisson Rony Escobar-Valencia of being in the country illegally after a prior removal, according to court documents, and he is expected to be deported back to El Salvador — exactly where he was attempting to go when he was detained.

His case underscores the complexities of self-deportation as the Trump admin-

istration steps up its crackdown on illegal immigrants. This year, the federal government launched an ad campaign urging undocumented migrants to go home.

In May, the Department of Homeland Security said it would pay people \$1,000 to self-deport, calling the offer a "historic opportunity for illegal aliens." Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem stated in February that those who are caught in America illegally will never have the chance to return,

while those who self-deport "may have an opportunity to return and enjoy our freedom and live the American Dream."

It's unclear how many people have self-deported, though Homeland Security has touted the program as a success.

Escobar-Valencia, 30, was brought to the Bay Area at 11 years old by his father, who had obtained temporary protected status due to unsafe conditions in El Salvador, according to court

[See Self-deport, A14]

Trump civil fraud penalty is tossed

Appellate panel rejects a verdict that would have cost the president \$515 million. **NATION, A5**

Southland faces intense heat wave

Experts warn of triple-digit temperatures that raise health and fire risks. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather

Mostly sunny and hot. L.A. Basin: 94/73. **B6**

Markets **A12**
Opinion Voices **A13**

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ALLEN J. SCHABEN L.A. Times

Palmer takes up coaching in O.C.

Ex-USC and NFL star quarterback embraces the challenges at alma mater Santa Margarita High. **SPORTS, B10**



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